

Functional Impact Translation Guide

03

Enterprise function-family prompts, risk lenses, support needs, and likely outputs

Functional Impact Translation helps teams understand how the same change lands differently across functions, roles, and levels. It prevents the framework from stopping at “who needs a message” and instead asks what must be true for the change to work across the enterprise.

Important guardrail

Use functional competencies to understand the work and how change may affect it. Do not use this guide to evaluate individual performance.

How to use this guide

1. Identify impacted functions.
2. Identify each function’s role in the change: sponsor, owner, approver, enabler, leader, impacted user, or adjacent audience.
3. Identify how work changes by function.
4. Identify decisions, behaviors, handoffs, systems, or workflows that shift.
5. Identify risks if the function is missed.
6. Identify support needed: training, job aid, dashboard, legal review, leader toolkit, huddle guide, support path, or measurement plan.
7. Feed these findings into the activation roadmap.

Role in the change

Role	Description	Typical support
Executive Sponsor	Sets direction, risk tolerance, and strategic intent.	Executive narrative, decision brief, risk view.
Business / Product Owner	Owns scope, timing, capability, and business outcome.	Change charter, roadmap, stakeholder map.
Program Owner	Coordinates execution, dependencies, and decision follow-through.	Activation roadmap, milestones, risk log.
Functional Owner	Owns how the change lands in their function.	Functional impact map, readiness plan.
Approver / Reviewer	Validates accuracy, risk, language, compliance, or readiness.	Review packet, decision deadline.
Enabling Partner	Builds support materials, training, analytics, process, or tools.	Workstream plan, asset list.
People Leader	Translates, reinforces, and escalates.	Leader toolkit, huddle guide, FAQ.
Impacted Team Member	Adopts the change in day-to-day work.	Clear explanation, training, job aid, support path.

Role	Description	Typical support
Adjacent Audience	Needs awareness because work connects to the change.	Awareness message, reference resource.

Enterprise functional impact taxonomy

Functional family	Functions included	Primary change lens	Key questions	Likely outputs
Product and Customer Experience	Product Management, Product Design, Technical Product Management, Site Experience	Customer journey, product strategy, roadmap, usability, technical constraints	Does this alter the customer or user journey? Does it affect roadmap, prioritization, UX, adoption, or product success metrics?	Product brief, journey impact, UX/content review, success metrics.
Engineering and Technical Delivery	Software Engineering, Software Engineering People Leader, Infrastructure, Quality Engineering, Technical Product, TPM, Data Engineering, ML Engineering	Systems, architecture, release readiness, testing, performance, reliability, security, technical debt	Does this affect system behavior, integrations, observability, testing, incident response, security, or fallback plans?	Technical readiness plan, UAT plan, rollback plan, release notes, support model.
Data, Analytics, Science, and ML	Analytics, BI Engineering, Data Engineering, Data Science, Research Science, ML Engineering	Measurement, data quality, dashboards, models, insights, governance	What data will prove the change is working? Are definitions, dashboards, models, data pipelines, and reporting owners ready?	Measurement plan, dashboard, metric definitions, data quality checks, adoption reporting.
Program and Project Execution	Program Management, Project Management, Technical Program Management	Dependencies, sequencing, milestones, risk management, decision tracking	Who owns the roadmap? What dependencies, blockers, gates, and escalation paths exist?	Roadmap, RACI, dependency tracker, risk log, decision log, status cadence.
Operations and Frontline Execution	CC Operations, FC Operations, Instock, Site Experience	Daily workflow, staffing, leader routines, quality, safety, customer experience, adoption	What changes in daily work? Are leaders ready to coach it? Are staffing, SLAs, quality, safety, and escalation paths clear?	Operational readiness plan, leader toolkit, huddle guide, SOP update, escalation path.
People, Talent, and Organizational Support	HRBP, Recruiting, Recruiting Coordinator, TA Marketing, Executive Assistant	Role impact, Team Member experience, candidate experience, leader support, confidentiality, logistics	Does this affect roles, reporting, hiring, compensation, engagement, org design, scheduling, or sensitive people information?	HR review, leader talking points, 1:1 guide, FAQ, confidentiality guidance.
Commercial, Vendor, Supply Chain, and Finance	Category Management, Private Brands Sourcing, Instock, Finance Business Partner	P&L, vendors, forecasting, inventory, contracts, budgets, assortment, supply	Does this affect vendors, pricing, assortment, inventory, purchasing, contracts, or financial planning?	Vendor plan, financial impact view, sourcing timeline, inventory plan.
Legal, Compliance, and Professional Judgment	Legal Counsel, Veterinary Professional	Legal risk, regulatory boundaries, licensing, professional standards, customer trust	Does this require legal review, professional judgment, licensing considerations, approved language, auditability, or clinical/compliance guardrails?	Legal review, approved language, compliance notes, professional guidance, escalation criteria.
Learning, Creative, Brand, and Storytelling	Instructional Design, Marketing Creative, Studio Post Production, TA Marketing, Product Design	Learning design, behavior change, brand consistency, content quality, storytelling	Is this awareness, understanding, enablement, or behavior change? What training, creative, or brand standards are needed?	Learning plan, job aid, creative brief, brand guardrails, content production timeline.
Executive and Administrative Enablement	Executive Assistant, Program Management, HRBP, Finance	Executive readiness, meeting cadence, decision prep, logistics, confidentiality	Which leaders need preparation? What decisions need time on calendars? What materials are needed before leadership forums?	Briefing packet, meeting plan, decision calendar, follow-up tracker.

Functional impact translation template

Function	Role in change	Impact	What shifts?	Risk if missed	Support needed	Owner
[Function]	[Sponsor / Owner / Enabler / Impacted / Adjacent]	[Direct / Indirect]	[Decision, behavior, workflow, system, handoff, or expectation]	[Confusion, rework, delay, compliance risk, customer friction, TM concern]	[Training, FAQ, dashboard, review, huddle, job aid, support path]	[Name / team]
[Function]						
[Function]						

Function-specific decision prompts

Product and Customer Experience

- Does the change affect the customer or user journey?
- Does it change what customers, Team Members, vendors, candidates, or partners see or do?
- Does it affect roadmap, prioritization, UX, adoption, or product success metrics?
- What tradeoffs have been made, and who understands them?

Engineering, Quality, Infrastructure, and Technical Product

- Does this affect production systems, integrations, data flows, access, reliability, observability, or security?
- What testing, UAT, monitoring, or fallback plans are required?
- What technical risks should non-technical stakeholders understand in plain language?
- What support path exists if something breaks?

Data, Analytics, BI, Science, and ML

- What data will show whether the change is working?
- Are metric definitions clear?
- Are dashboards or reports ready?
- Are there data quality, model quality, or governance risks?
- Who owns ongoing measurement?

Operations and Frontline Execution

- What changes in daily work?
- Who needs to coach, reinforce, or inspect the change?
- Are staffing, SLAs, quality standards, safety standards, or escalation paths affected?
- What will leaders need before impacted teams hear about the change?

HR, Talent, Recruiting, and Organizational Support

- Does this affect roles, reporting, staffing, schedules, pay, performance expectations, hiring, candidate experience, or Team Member engagement?
- Does it require 1:1 conversations or leader coaching?
- Could it create fairness, confidentiality, or policy concerns?
- What leader guidance is needed before activation?

Learning and Instructional Design

- Is this awareness, understanding, enablement, or behavior change?
- Do people need practice or just information?
- Is the gap caused by knowledge, process, tooling, confidence, or role clarity?
- How will learning effectiveness be measured?

Legal, Compliance, and Professional Judgment

- Does this require legal, regulatory, licensing, privacy, policy, or clinical review?
- Does any language need to be approved?
- Could this affect customer trust or professional standards?
- Does the change require auditability or documentation?

Commercial, Vendor, Supply Chain, and Finance

- Does this affect vendors, contracts, pricing, inventory, assortment, sourcing, forecasting, budgets, or P&L?
- Are external partners affected?
- Are there financial tradeoffs or cost assumptions leaders need to understand?
- What business metrics should be monitored?

Creative, Brand, Content, and Storytelling

- Does this need internal storytelling, external storytelling, employer brand support, creative assets, or visual explanation?
- What language or creative treatment could overstate, confuse, or create risk?
- What brand standards apply?
- What assets need to be created before activation?

Output rules

If the change includes...	Then the activation roadmap should include...
Daily workflow impact	Leader toolkit, job aid, huddle guidance, reinforcement, escalation path.
Tool or system change	Training, demo, UAT summary, launch support, known issues, fallback plan.
AI or automation	Support-role framing, human judgment boundaries, leader FAQ, narrative guardrails.
Role, staffing, schedule, pay, or reporting impact	HR review, 1:1 conversation guide, leader talking points, Team Member FAQ.
Customer-facing impact	Customer experience impact review, support guidance, customer-facing language if needed.
Legal, compliance, privacy, or veterinary sensitivity	Legal/professional review, approved language, documentation expectations.
Data, dashboard, metric, or reporting change	Metric definitions, dashboard owner, measurement cadence, data quality checks.
Broad enterprise visibility	Executive narrative, stakeholder pressure test, leader cascade, channel sequencing.

Source basis

This knowledge document was generated from the source materials listed below. It is intended to make the custom GPT's reference library cleaner and easier to follow; it is not a substitute for human review.

- Functional competency models across Product, Engineering, Data, Program/Project, Operations, HR/Talent, Commercial/Finance, Legal/Veterinary, Learning/Creative, and Executive/Admin functions.
- Functional competency models describe knowledge, skills, and abilities by job family and career level; this guide distills those models for change planning only.
- Change Navigation Strategic Framework.